

# FINDING

## Wave-3e multipass regression finding (§11.4.138 / §11.4.102 / §11.4.108)

**Date:** 2026-06-16 **Build HEAD:** 6d544c5 **Found by:** AI (wave-3e recording unit)

### Symptom

unified-translator -multipass (both default 1 pass AND -multipass-passes 2) produces a CORRUPTED output artifact: the LLM's polishing-instruction meta-response is written as the translation instead of the polished text. Observed outputs:

- 1 pass: [Ту версион мехорада ен диалекто Екавица, о UNCHANGED си ла традуксион ес перфекта]
- 2 pass: [No text provided for translation. Please supply the Spanish translation to be assessed.]

### §11.4.108 SOURCE/report→ARTIFACT gap (the bluff)

The session report (mp1\_session\_report.md) reports ALL green: Step 4: Multi-pass Polishing  Success – Polished over 1 pass(es) with deepseek and mp1.epub  Verified — while the real EPUB content is the meta-response garbage above. Green report, broken artifact = §11.4 PASS-bluff.

### Root cause (FACT-grade, Phase 1)

The multipass polishing path writes the LLM polishing response directly as the new translation with NO guard against the LLM returning an instruction-echo / meta-response / UNCHANGED-marker instead of polished prose. The prior 20260615 video-confirmation got a clean polish response by chance; the path is non-deterministic and unsafe.

## **Impact on Status.md**

Row 452 (verification | Multi-pass polisher, cited helixtranslate-cli-multipass-verify-20260615.mp4) was marked PASS — video-confirmed. The feature is BROKEN at runtime now → demoted to PENDING\_FORENSICS, video-confirmed count 41 → 40.

## **Required follow-up (separate source-fix work item, NOT this docs wave)**

TDD §11.4.43/§11.4.115: RED test feeding a meta-response polish reply → assert output FALLS BACK to the pre-polish translation (never writes the meta-text). Then re-record + re-confirm.